

BACK

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LUTER GRANULES

Description

Yellow, orange flavoured granules. Upon reconstitution, a yellow suspension is obtained.

Composition

Each 5 ml contains:
Artemether 15 mg
Lumefantrine 90 mg
Preservatives:
Methyl Hydroxybenzoate 0.12 % w/v
Propyl Hydroxybenzoate 0.02 % w/v

Actions and Pharmacology

Artemether is an artemisinin derivative which has largely replaced artemisinin in practice. It is a potent and rapidly acting blood schizontocidal active against *Plasmodium vivax* and against both chloroquine-sensitive and chloroquine-resistant strains of *P. falciparum*. Lumefantrine is a blood schizontocidal with a relatively slow onset of action but it has a longer duration of action than Artemether.

Pharmacokinetics

Peak plasma concentrations have been achieved in about 3 hours after oral doses of Artemether. Artemisinin derivatives are all rapidly hydrolysed to the active metabolite dihydroartemisinin. Reported elimination half-life has been about 4 hours to 11 hours after oral Artemether.

Bioavailability of Lumefantrine after oral doses is variable; absorption begins after a lag-time of up to 2 hours and bioavailability is substantially increased when given with food, particularly meals high in fat. Peak plasma concentrations occur after about 6 to 8 hours. Lumefantrine is almost completely protein bound. It is considered to be metabolized mainly in the liver and is excreted in the faeces. The elimination half-life is reported to be between 4 to 6 days in patients with malaria.

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Indications

For treatment of uncomplicated falciparum malaria.

Contraindications

LUTER is contraindicated in:

- Patients with known hypersensitivity to the active substances or to any of the excipients.
- Patients with severe malaria according to WHO definition.
- Patients who are taking any drug which is metabolized by the cytochrome enzyme CYP2D6, for examples are flecainide, metoprolol, imipramine, amitriptyline, clomipramine.
- Patients with a family history of sudden death or of congenital prolongation of the QTc interval on electrocardiograms, or with any other clinical condition known to prolong the QTc interval.
- Patients with a history of symptomatic cardiac arrhythmias or with clinically relevant bradycardia or with congestive cardiac failure accompanied by reduced left ventricle ejection fraction.
- Patients with disturbances of electrolyte balance such as hypokalaemia or hypomagnesaemia.
- Patients taking drugs that are known to prolong the QTc interval. These drugs include antiarrhythmics of classes IA and III, neuroleptics, antidepressant agents, certain antibiotics including some agents of the macrolides, fluorquinolones, imidazole and triazole classes, certain non-sedating antihistamines (terfenadine, astemizole), cisapride.

Precautions

- Caution is advised when administering LUTER to patients with severe renal, hepatic or cardiac problems. In these patients, ECG and blood potassium monitoring is advised.
- If patient deteriorates when taking LUTER, alternative treatment for malaria should be started without delay.
- LUTER should not be administered earlier than one month after the last halofantrine dose.
- LUTER has the potential to cause QT prolongation.
- Patients who remain averse to food during treatment should be monitored closely as the risk of recrudescence may be greater.

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Pregnancy and Lactation

- Do not consume LUTER in the first trimester of pregnancy in situations where other suitable and effective anti-malarials are available.
- Women taking LUTER should not breastfeed during the treatment. It is recommended that breastfeeding should not resume until at least one week after the last dose of LUTER.

Interaction with other Medicaments

- The concurrent oral administration of ketoconazole with LUTER led to a modest increase in Artemether, DHA, and Lumefantrine exposure in healthy adult subjects. This increase in exposure to the antimalarial combination was not associated with increased side effects or changes in electrocardiographic parameters. Thus, dose adjustment of LUTER is considered unnecessary in falciparum malaria patients when administered in association with ketoconazole or other potent CYP3A4 inhibitors.
- Artemisinins have some capacity to induce CYP3A4 and CYP2C19 and inhibit CYP2D6 and CYP1A2. This may alter therapeutic response of drugs that are predominantly metabolized by these enzymes.
- Lumefantrine was found to inhibit CYP2D6 in vitro. Co-administration of LUTER with drugs that are metabolized by this isoenzyme is contraindicated. Lumefantrine metabolism is inhibited by halofantrine and quinine.
- Use of protease inhibitor anti-retroviral drugs with LUTER requires clinical surveillance and monitoring of clinical response / undesirable effects due to variable patterns of inhibition, induction or competition for CYP3A4.
- Administration of LUTER is contra-indicated in patients taking drugs that are known to prolong the QTc interval.
- LUTER should not be given concurrently with any other antimalarial agent. If quinine is given after LUTER, close monitoring of ECG is advised.

Main Side/Adverse Effects

- Headache, dizziness, sleep disturbance, palpitations, gastrointestinal disturbances, anorexia, pruritus, rash, cough, arthralgia, myalgia and fatigue.

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Overdose

Treatment of overdose: In case of suspected overdose, symptomatic and supportive therapy should be given as appropriate, which should include ECG and blood potassium monitoring.

Dosage and Administration

For oral administration.

Adults and children weighing 35 kg and above: A course of treatment comprises six doses of 80 mg Artemether and 480 mg Lumefantrine at the time of initial diagnosis, 8, 24, 36, 48, 60 hours thereafter.

Children weighing 25 to less than 35 kg: A course of treatment comprises six doses of 60 mg Artemether and 360 mg Lumefantrine at the time of initial diagnosis, 8, 24, 36, 48, 60 hours thereafter.

Children weighing 15 to less than 25 kg: A course of treatment comprises six doses of 40 mg Artemether and 240 mg Lumefantrine at the time of initial diagnosis, 8, 24, 36, 48, 60 hours thereafter.

Children weighing 5 to less than 15 kg: A course of treatment comprises six doses of 20 mg Artemether and 120 mg Lumefantrine at the time of initial diagnosis, 8, 24, 36, 48, 60 hours thereafter.

Note: The information given here is limited. For further information consult your doctor or pharmacist.

Storage : Store below 30°C.
Presentation/Packing : Bottle of 60 ml.

Marketing authorization holder: HOVID Bhd.
121, Jalan Tunku Abdul Rahman, 30010 Ipoh, Malaysia.

Manufactured by: HOVID Bhd.
Lot 5644/2, 7 1/2 Miles, Jalan Ipoh/Chenor, 31200 Chenor, Malaysia.

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